

CASE STUDY 2

Project Connect: Improving CRM Adoption at TechNova Solutions

Company Background

TechNova Solutions Pvt. Ltd. is a leading IT consulting and software services company headquartered in Pune. Established in 2012, the company provides Application Development, Cloud Migration, CRM Implementation, Data Analytics, and Digital Transformation solutions to clients across Banking, Manufacturing, Retail, Healthcare, and Logistics.

The company employs **5,500 professionals** and serves more than **120 enterprise clients** across India and the Middle East. In FY2025, TechNova reported an annual revenue of **₹1,250 crore**.

To support future growth, the company invested nearly **₹25 crore** in implementing a new cloud-based CRM platform across its Sales, Marketing, and Customer Success teams. The objective was to improve lead management, increase sales productivity, strengthen customer relationships, and provide management with real-time business insights.

However, six months after implementation, the leadership team has observed that the CRM system is not delivering the expected business outcomes.

The CEO has appointed your consulting team to identify the reasons behind the poor adoption of the CRM platform and recommend strategies to maximize its business value.

Current Business Situation

Although the CRM system has been successfully deployed across the organization, employees continue to rely on spreadsheets, emails, and manual tracking methods for managing customer information.

Sales managers have reported inconsistent pipeline visibility, while the marketing team finds it difficult to measure campaign effectiveness due to incomplete customer data. Customer Success teams have also highlighted delays in resolving customer issues because information is scattered across multiple systems.

Senior management believes that the technology itself is functioning well, but employees are not fully utilizing its capabilities.

Business Performance

CRM Adoption

Metric	Before CRM	Current
CRM Adoption Rate	-	48%
Manual Excel Usage	95%	52%

Sales Performance

Metric	Before CRM	Current
Lead Conversion Rate	20%	18%
Average Sales Cycle	55 Days	68 Days

Customer Experience

Metric	Before CRM	Current
Customer Satisfaction (CSAT)	4.5/5	4.2/5
Customer Response Time	12 Hours	18 Hours

Industry Context

Many leading IT consulting firms are leveraging CRM platforms integrated with Artificial Intelligence, workflow automation, and analytics to improve customer engagement and sales performance. Organizations that achieve high CRM adoption often experience better customer retention, improved forecasting, and increased sales productivity.

TechNova wants to ensure that its CRM investment generates measurable business value and supports long-term digital transformation goals.

Questions

As a consulting team, you have been asked to answer the following questions:

1. Why is the CRM platform not being fully adopted by employees?
 2. Which business functions are most affected by poor CRM adoption?
 3. What are the possible reasons for declining sales productivity and customer satisfaction?
 4. What recommendations would you provide to improve CRM adoption and business performance?
 5. Prepare a roadmap to achieve **90% CRM adoption within the next 12 months**.
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Candidate Instructions

You have **25–30 minutes** to analyze the case and present your recommendations.

While solving the case:

- Identify the key business problem.
 - State any assumptions made.
 - Select an appropriate framework.
 - Analyze the available information.
 - Prioritize recommendations.
 - Present a structured solution to the CEO.
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Solution

Q1. Why is the CRM platform not being fully adopted by employees?

The CRM implementation challenge is primarily driven by **people and process issues rather than technology**. Employees continue using familiar tools like spreadsheets and emails because of limited training, resistance to change, and the absence of standardized CRM usage across departments.

Key Reasons

Issue	Impact
Resistance to change	Employees continue manual processes
Inadequate training	Low confidence in CRM usage
Lack of standard processes	Inconsistent data entry
No leadership monitoring	Low accountability

Conclusion: The CRM system is available, but user adoption remains low due to poor change management.

Q2. Which business functions are most affected by poor CRM adoption?

Business Function	Impact
Sales	Poor pipeline visibility and lower lead conversion
Marketing	Difficulty measuring campaign effectiveness
Customer Success	Delayed customer issue resolution
Management	Inaccurate reporting and forecasting

Conclusion: Poor CRM adoption affects decision-making across the organization.

Q3. What are the possible reasons for declining sales productivity and customer satisfaction?

Sales Productivity

- Incomplete customer information
- Manual lead tracking
- Longer sales cycle
- Poor collaboration between teams

Customer Satisfaction

- Slow response time
- Delayed issue resolution
- Inconsistent customer communication
- Lack of complete customer history

Observation: Low CRM adoption directly impacts both sales efficiency and customer experience.

Q4. What recommendations would you provide to improve CRM adoption and business performance?

Focus Area	Recommendation
People	Conduct CRM training and awareness sessions
Process	Standardize CRM usage across departments
Technology	Simplify workflows and improve system usability
Governance	Monitor CRM usage through KPIs and leadership reviews

Expected Outcome: Higher CRM adoption, improved collaboration, and better customer management.

Q5. Prepare a roadmap to achieve 90% CRM adoption within the next 12 months.

Timeline	Key Actions	Expected Outcome
0–3 Months	Employee training, define CRM guidelines, identify CRM champions	Increase awareness and initial adoption
3–6 Months	Standardize sales and customer support processes, monitor CRM usage	Improve process compliance
6–12 Months	Introduce dashboards, performance tracking, and incentives for CRM adoption	Achieve 90% adoption and improved business performance

Final Recommendation

TechNova should focus on **people, processes, and governance** rather than changing the CRM platform. By improving employee adoption, standardizing business processes, and continuously monitoring CRM usage, the company can enhance sales productivity, customer satisfaction, and maximize the return on its CRM investment.